

ULTIMATE TV BUYING CHEAT-SHEET

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To pick the right TV for your home this Diwali, you need to be familiar with popular trends and your own specific needs. Here are a few tips that will help you make the right choice.

1 Size matters

Choose the ideal TV size based on viewing or gaming distance, which should be around 1.5 to 2 times the screen size for optimal experience.

2 Display Type

Generally, the more you spend the better display type you can get. Affordable and mid-range TVs offer LED LCD and QLED displays. Premium TVs offer mini LED, OLED and QD-OLED technologies.

3 Display Performance

Regardless of the display technology employed, it's essential to consult reviews or gain firsthand experience to gauge the panel's calibration and performance accurately before making a purchase.

4 Motion Smoothening or MEMC

Many TVs advertise Motion Smoothening to reduce blur in fast-

moving scenes. This isn't necessarily an advantage and sometimes creates an unnatural, soap opera effect.

5 Types of HDR

HDR10 and Dolby Vision are the most popular HDR formats across OTT apps. HDR10+ and HLG are not as popular. Proprietary HDR labels like Auto HDR, Smart HDR, etc. might not actually imply HDR support.

6 HDR Impact

The impact of HDR depends on a number of factors including peak brightness, contrast and colour volume. Affordable HDR TVs are

often limited in one or more of these particular aspects.

7 Global Dimming

Global dimming is the most basic dimming technology used to enhance the contrast of LED LCD TVs. It is popular on affordable TV and is generally less effective than just the usual local dimming.

8 Local Dimming

Local dimming can dim or turn off portions of the backlight to enhance contrast. Its effectiveness differs across TVs. It depends on zone count and the quality of the brand's dimming algorithms.

9 High refresh rate is only for gaming

Unlike on smartphones, a high refresh rate on TVs is needed only for gaming. 60Hz is sufficient for most content even with MEMC being used to enhance motion smoothness.

10 HDMI 2.1

In 2023, most TVs with HDMI 2.1 ports lack the full HDMI 2.1 bandwidth required for 120Hz gaming, though they often support popular HDMI 2.1 features like eARC (Enhanced Audio Return Channel) and ALLM (Auto Low Latency Mode). This makes the case for HDMI 2.1 stronger.

